HostMate – Design Document

Budget fit, event hit!

Prepared for AI Studio, to modify and extend the HostMate website. Version 1.0, 30 October 2026.

1. Purpose and scope

HostMate is an event-planning website for Indian celebrations such as weddings, sangeets and anniversaries. It helps hosts stay inside a budget, track tasks, collect RSVPs on WhatsApp and manage vendors.

This document describes two connected designs that should become one site:

1. **Marketing landing page.** A classy, photo-led page that appeals to couples and families. Its layout follows a reference of a gold-and-white event-planner site.
2. **Planner app.** A logged-in workspace with an event header, five tabs and a dark budget “vault”. It follows the original HostMate screenshot.

The goal for AI Studio is to keep the look, structure and tone described here while changing or adding features. Anything not listed under “Fixed” in section 12 can be modified.

2. Brand and tone

- **Name:** HostMate. **Tagline:** “Budget fit, event hit!”
- **Personality:** warm, refined, trustworthy. Think printed wedding stationery: ivory paper, gold foil, deep green ink.
- **Voice:** calm and reassuring, in plain English with Hindi available. Short sentences. No jargon, no exclamation marks except the tagline.
- **Logo:** a circular monogram “HM” in a serif face, with a thin gold ring, next to the wordmark “HostMate”.
- **Currency and numbers:** Indian format, for example ₹15,00,000. Dates are shown as “20 Nov 2026”.

3. Visual language

3.1 Colour tokens

Define all colours as CSS variables on `:root`. Provide dark values under `@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark)` and a manual `data-theme` override.

Token	Light	Dark	Use
`--bg` (landing)	#fffdf9	#13110d	Page background
`--bg` (app)	#f8f3ea	#14120f	App background
`--surface`	#fffdf8	#1d1a15	Cards, header
`--ink`	#23201b / #2a2418	#f3ecdc	Main text
`--muted`	#6f675a / #7a705c	#a79d89	Secondary text
`--line`	#e6dcc8	#3a3327	Borders
`--gold`	#b49a45 (landing), #b78f3b (app)	same	Accents, buttons, gold blocks
`--emerald`	#12392d	same	App primary, budget vault
`--emerald2`	#1c5340	same	Secondary green buttons
`--night`	#0d1220	same	Photo and illustration backdrops
`--rose`	#f1dcd3	#3a2a24	Event icon background
`--warn`	#a5562a	same	Warning text

Rules: gold blocks carry ivory text (#fffaf0). The vault uses a gradient from #12392d to #0c2a21 with a 1px gold border. Never use pure black or pure white for large areas.

3.2 Typography

- **Display:** Cormorant Garamond (500, 600, italic 500). Used for logo, headings, numbers and quotes.
- **Body and UI:** Jost (300 on the landing page, 400 and 500 in the app).
- Fallbacks: Georgia for display, system-ui for body.

Element	Size	Notes
Landing hero headline	clamp(28px, 5.2vw, 52px)	Weight 400, letter-spacing 0.28em, line-height 1.35, max 12 characters per line
Hero tagline	20px italic	Letter-spacing 0.06em, colour #eadcae
Section label (e.g. SERVICES)	22px	Letter-spacing 0.3em, uppercase
App page title (vault)	44px	Line-height 1.05
Event title	38px	
Body text	16px / 1.6	
Small and meta text	13–14.5px	
Buttons on landing	12px	Uppercase, letter-spacing 0.2em

3.3 Shape, spacing and effects

- **Landing page:** sharp rectangles, no rounded corners, thin 1px outlines. Gold blocks are flat colour.
- **App:** generous rounding. Cards 20px, vault 28px, inner panels 16px, buttons and chips fully pill-shaped (99px).
- Content width: 1080–1120px, centred, with 20–28px side padding.
- Gaps between blocks: 22px on the landing page, 26–28px in the app.
- Shadows are minimal. Depth comes from borders, gradients and the gold logo ring (`0 0 0 3px surface, 0 0 0 4px gold`).
- Motion is subtle and optional: twinkling string lights, a 1.4s ease on the budget ring, a 0.5s expand on the services panel. All motion must stop when `prefers-reduced-motion` is set.

3.4 Imagery

The current build uses inline SVG illustrations because the host cannot load outside images. When real photography is available, use:

- **Hero:** a night outdoor wedding tent lit by string lights under large trees (wide, 1200×560, dark edges so text stays readable).

- **Services:** a close, warm, blurred crowd or bokeh-lights shot.
- **Gallery:** a long banquet table under a tented ceiling with garlands, candles and fresh flowers.
- All photos need a darkening overlay of about 25% under any text and descriptive alt text.

4. Landing page structure

Order from top to bottom. Each section lists its content and behaviour.

4.1 Top navigation

- Left: logo monogram and wordmark.
- Right: Home, Services, Stories, Gallery, Contact. 13px, letter-spacing 0.08em, gold on hover.
- Wraps onto two lines on narrow screens. Links jump to section anchors with smooth scrolling.

4.2 Hero

- Full-width night scene, height min(78vh, 560px), minimum 380px.
- Centred headline “Creating unforgettable memories”, the tagline below it, then a ghost button “PLAN MY EVENT” that links to Contact.
- Ghost button: 1px ivory border, fills ivory with dark text on hover.

4.3 Services

- Two-column grid, 5fr and 7fr, 22px gap. Stacks to one column below 760px.
- Left: gold block with label “SERVICES”, a small line-art lotus ornament, the line “Turn your dream into a reality” and a ghost button “DISCOVER”.
- Right: photo block with warm bokeh lights and a silhouette of two guests.
- “Discover” expands four outlined boxes beneath the row: **Budget tracker**, **WhatsApp RSVP**, **Vendor hub**, **AI ideas**. Each has a title in gold and one sentence. The button sets `aria-expanded`.

4.4 Stories (testimonials)

- Centred quote with a large opening quote mark, 24px serif italic-style text, and the couple's name in gold capitals at 12px.
- Left and right arrow buttons cycle through three testimonials. Content is announced politely to screen readers.
- Sample stories: Aarav & Priya (wedding), Mehra Family (anniversary), Neha & Karan (sangeet).

4.5 Gallery

- A wide photo (min height 380px) with a gold card overlapping on the right: label "GALLERY", ornament, "Unforgettable moments", button "DISCOVER".
- Gold card is 330px wide (70% on small screens) and centres on mobile.

4.6 Footer and contact

- Full-width gold bar. Four columns: studio address, phone and email with hours, a one-line promise, and a ghost button "BOOK A CONSULTATION" (mailto link).
- Placeholder details to replace: HostMate Studio, Cyber Hub, Gurugram, Haryana 122002; +91 98100 00000; hello@hostmate.example; Mon–Sat 10am–7pm.

5. Planner app structure

5.1 App header

- Row 1: logo, tagline in italic serif, language switch ("हिन्दी (Hindi)" and "English") and a Dark/Light toggle.
- Row 2: a green pill button "Reconfigure event", an event selector (for example "Aarav & Priya's Wedding"), and tab navigation: **Budget tracker**, **Checklist & timeline**, **WhatsApp RSVP**, **Vendor hub**, **AI ideas**.
- The active tab has a 2px gold underline and medium weight. Tabs scroll horizontally on small screens.

5.2 Event summary card

- Rounded card with a round rose icon (ring emoji or icon), event name, a "Wedding" tag chip (gold-soft background), and a meta row: date with days-to-go countdown, guest count, total budget.

- Right side actions: green “Preview guest RSVP” and dark “AI ideas” pills.
- Sample data: 20 Nov 2026, 250 guests, ₹15,00,000. The days-to-go figure is calculated from today’s date.

5.3 Budget vault (Budget tracker tab)

- Dark emerald panel with gold border. Title “Core budget tracker” and description “Track estimated and actual spend, advance deposits and balance due dates in one place.”
- A status chip shows “Approaching limit (90%)”. Rules: under 86% shows “On track”, 86–100% shows “Approaching limit”, over 100% shows “Over budget”.
- Header buttons: outlined “AI budget optimizer” (toggles a tip) and gold “+ Add budget item” (reveals an inline form).
- Circular gauge (180px) showing the share of budget used, drawn as an SVG arc in light gold.
- Four KPI cards: Total budget, Actual spend, Paid so far, Balance due.
- Table columns: Item, Estimated, Actual, Paid, Balance, Status. Status is “Paid in full” (green chip) or “Deposit paid” (gold chip).
- Sample rows (₹): Venue 4,50,000 / 4,20,000 / 2,00,000; Catering 4,00,000 / 3,80,000 / 1,50,000; Decor 2,00,000 / 2,10,000 / 80,000; Photography 1,50,000 / 1,50,000 / 75,000; Attire 1,20,000 / 1,15,000 / 1,15,000; Music 80,000 / 80,000 / 30,000.

5.4 Other tabs

- **Checklist & timeline:** checkbox list with a due-date label on the right of each task.
- **WhatsApp RSVP:** summary cards for confirmed (164), declined (38) and waiting (48), plus a reminder action.
- **Vendor hub:** cards per vendor with category and the next payment or milestone.
- **AI ideas:** idea cards with a title, an estimated saving and a short reason.

6. Components library

Component	Spec
Primary pill (app)	Emerald background, #f6ecd0 text, 1px gold border, 11px 22px padding

Component	Spec
Secondary pill	Transparent, 1px line border, 8px 16px padding
Gold button (vault)	Gold fill, #1b1608 text, weight 600
Ghost button (landing)	Transparent, 1px currentColor border, 11px 28px, uppercase, spaced
Chip	99px radius, 12px text, 3px 12px padding
Card (app)	Surface background, 1px line border, 16–20px radius
Outline box (landing)	1px gold border, 20px padding, no radius
Input	12px radius, translucent white on vault, 10px 14px padding
Tab	14px text, 10px 16px padding, bottom border 2px

Focus state for every interactive element: 2px gold outline with 2–3px offset.

7. Responsive behaviour

- Breakpoint at 700–760px.
- Below it: services grid becomes one column, gallery gold card centres, app stats stack (gauge above KPIs), vault padding reduces from 34px to 24px, vault title from 44px to 36px, tabs take the full width.
- Wide tables sit in a horizontally scrolling container so the page never scrolls sideways.
- Keep content clear of device notches using `env(safe-area-inset-*)` padding and `viewport-fit=cover`.

8. Accessibility

- Text contrast at least 4.5:1. Check ivory text on #b49a45 gold at large sizes only, or darken the gold to #8f7830 for small text.
- Tabs use `role="tablist"`, `role="tab"` and `aria-selected`. Panels use `role="tabpanel"`.
- Icon-only buttons need `aria-label`. Decorative SVGs use `aria-hidden="true"`.

- Support keyboard navigation (Tab, Enter, Space) and add arrow-key movement between tabs in the next version.
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion` and `prefers-color-scheme`.

9. Localisation

- English is the default. Hindi is switchable. The current build translates the tagline and tab names; the next version should translate every visible string through a dictionary file.
- Load a Devanagari-capable font (for example Noto Serif Devanagari for headings and Noto Sans Devanagari for body) when Hindi is active.
- Use `Intl.NumberFormat('en-IN')` for currency in both languages.

10. Technical notes

- Single self-contained HTML file, CSS and JavaScript inline. No build step.
- External resources allowed: Google Fonts only. No remote images. Embed images as data URIs or inline SVG, and keep the file under 16 MB.
- Browser storage can hold per-viewer conveniences (theme choice, last tab). Wrap every read and write in try/catch. For data that must persist across devices, such as budget items and RSVPs, use a real backend.
- Budget logic: percentage used equals total of actual spend divided by total budget, rounded to a whole number. Balance for an item is actual minus paid.
- Sanitise any user-entered text before inserting it into the page.

11. Suggested modifications for AI Studio

Priority order:

1. Join both designs under one navigation: landing page for visitors, “Open planner” button that leads to the app.
2. Replace illustrations with real photography and add a lightbox to the gallery.
3. Persist budget items, checklist state and RSVPs in a database, with login.
4. Connect “WhatsApp RSVP” to the WhatsApp Business API and show live reply counts.
5. Make “AI budget optimizer” and “AI ideas” call a language model with the event type, budget, guest count and city, returning saving tips in English or Hindi.

6. Add event templates (wedding, sangeet, birthday, corporate) that pre-fill budget categories and checklists.
7. Add charts: spend by category and payments by month.
8. Add export of the budget as PDF or spreadsheet.
9. Add a vendor directory with ratings, quotes and payment reminders.

12. Fixed rules and flexible areas

Fixed (keep as designed):

- Name, tagline and the HM monogram.
- Ivory, emerald and gold palette, with Cormorant Garamond and Jost.
- Layout order of the landing page and the dark emerald budget vault.
- Indian currency and date formatting.
- Light and dark theme support.

Flexible (may change):

- Imagery, sample data and testimonials.
- Copy wording, provided the calm tone is kept.
- Extra tabs, charts and integrations from section 11.
- Exact spacing, as long as the proportions and breakpoints hold.

13. Ready-to-paste prompt for AI Studio

> Modify the HostMate event-planning website using the attached design document as the source of truth. Keep the ivory, emerald and gold palette, Cormorant Garamond with Jost typography, and the layouts in sections 4 and 5. Keep the landing page structure (hero, services, stories, gallery, footer) and the dark emerald budget vault. Then implement the modifications in section 11 in priority order, starting with joining the landing page and the planner under one navigation. Use inline SVG or embedded images only. Keep light and dark themes, English and Hindi, Indian currency formatting, and the accessibility rules in section 8. Explain each change you make in one or two sentences.